



Chloe Cho <ccho@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Federico Danieli

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Sun, Jan 31, 2021 at 8:44 AM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Federico Danieli

Gender

Male

Nationality

Italy

Emailfederico.danieli@maths.ox.ac.uk**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

University of Oxford

City, state, and country of residence

Oxford, Oxfordshire, UK

University education

- Doctor of Philosophy, Applied Mathematics, University of Oxford, 09/16 - 07/21 (expected)
- Master of Science, Computational Science and Engineering, ETH Zürich, 09/13 - 09/15
- Bachelor of Science, Mathematical Engineering, Politecnico di Milano, 09/09 - 09/12

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

The main reason for applying to Science Corps comes from my personal experience. My family is not from a particularly wealthy background, and we had to undergo some sacrifices in order for me to gain access to the excellent education that I can now pride myself of. While I consider myself extremely lucky for the chances I had in life, my experience also made me sensitive to the unfairness associated with having one's background dictate the type of education they can have access to, and I personally became aware of the fundamental role

played by education in empowering individuals. As such, I consider it as part of my responsibilities to try and share my luck with people in worse situations than me.

Additionally, I'm an avid traveller, having managed to touch every continent in the last few years (back when travelling was still a possibility!), and always seeking to visit new places and immerse myself in foreign cultures.

Science Corps would provide me with the best opportunity to combine both these passions of mine, as well as to further refine my teaching skills in a particularly challenging environment.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

In September 2018 I helped designing and delivering a one-week course at the University of Yangon, in Myanmar, supported by the Oxford-Burma visiting fund. The aim of the course was to deepen the expertise of the academic staff in a specific area of Mathematics, and to train them on general educational techniques. The staff was enthusiastic about the experience, and during the visit we also set the background work for future partnerships between the Universities of Yangon and Oxford, in order to help shaping the curricula of the teaching programmes offered in Yangon. This experience has prepared me to tackle difficulties such as acclimatising in an unfamiliar environment, overcoming language barriers, and organising and delivering teaching material.

On top of this, during my PhD I have been Teaching Assistant and/or Tutor for more than 10 courses, delivering classes to small-sized groups (10~15) of undergraduate students. I also got involved in volunteering activities organised by the Oxford Hub, where I taught educationally disadvantaged pupils at the Cheney High School in Oxford.

Finally, I participated in the "Development Learning and Teaching" Programme, accredited by SEDA, aimed at equipping PhD Students with teaching strategies and helping them structuring their classes effectively.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry
Administrative role in industry or academia
In science education
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

During my PhD, I nurtured in parallel both my passions for Teaching and Education, and for applications of Mathematics in Industry. The plan for the next two years is to gain some additional, hands-on experience in both fields, by taking on a short-term position in R&D in industry, and another one more teaching-oriented.

I will then use these experiences to ultimately decide how to shape my career more long-term, depending on which one I found the most enjoyable and more aligned to my interests, consequently focusing on becoming either an educator, or a technical consultant.

In a sense, as is often the case at the end of a PhD, I find myself at a crossroads. The experience with Science Corps would be extremely valuable in helping me decide how to direct my next steps, by providing me with more real-world experience regarding the implications of a career involved in science education, particularly under the umbrella of a non-profit organisation.

CV/Resumé

[CV.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Institutional newsletter

Any extra comment or message.

I don't have any particular preference regarding the location, but I reckon I would be best suited for the position at the CVIF site in the Philippines. On top of my experience in creating and organising classes and teaching materials, in fact, I also have some familiarity with creating websites, so I could definitely help you making such material available online, thus expanding on the project you initiated.

Regarding the timeline, I'm expecting to hand-in my thesis around May this year, and sit my final exam towards August, depending on the availability of the examiners. I'm not sure if this would be in line with your schedule: if not, however, I would be glad if you could consider me for future positions as well.

Sent from Science Corps